

AMENDMENT NO. _____ Calendar No. _____

Purpose: In the nature of a substitute.

IN THE SENATE OF THE UNITED STATES—116th Cong., 2d Sess.

S. 3235

To direct the Secretary of Veterans Affairs to conduct a pilot program on posttraumatic growth, and for other purposes.

Referred to the Committee on _____ and
ordered to be printed

Ordered to lie on the table and to be printed

AMENDMENT IN THE NATURE OF A SUBSTITUTE intended
to be proposed by Mrs. LOEFFLER (for Ms. MCSALLY,
Mr. KAINE, and Mrs. LOEFFLER)

Viz:

1 Strike all after the enacting clause and insert the fol-
2 lowing:

3 **SECTION 1. SHORT TITLE.**

4 This Act may be cited as the “Veterans
5 Posttraumatic Growth Act”.

6 **SEC. 2. FINDINGS.**

7 Congress finds the following:

8 (1) There is a shortage of adequate, timely, and
9 effective mental health care available to veterans
10 across the United States.

1 (2) The Department of Veterans Affairs con-
2 tinues to highlight veterans mental health care and
3 suicide prevention as a key priority.

4 (3) There is an opportunity to explore effective
5 alternative treatments focused on the area of
6 posttraumatic growth.

7 **SEC. 3. PILOT PROGRAM ON POSTTRAUMATIC GROWTH.**

8 (a) PROGRAM.—The Secretary of Veterans Affairs
9 shall conduct a pilot program, through the Office of Whole
10 Health of the Department of Veterans Affairs, to study
11 the effectiveness and benefits of nonprofit posttraumatic
12 growth programs to determine—

13 (1) the outcomes of such programs in contrast
14 to traditional models of mental health care;

15 (2) the possible integration of such nonprofit
16 programs into the mental health care programs pro-
17 vided by the Secretary; and

18 (3) the budgetary impacts of such integration.

19 (b) REVIEW AND EVALUATION.—In developing the
20 pilot program under subsection (a), the Secretary shall—

21 (1) review relevant literature to summarize the
22 existing knowledge regarding posttraumatic growth
23 programs; and

24 (2) evaluate such programs.